



Soul Food Holiday

Truth Served, Daily

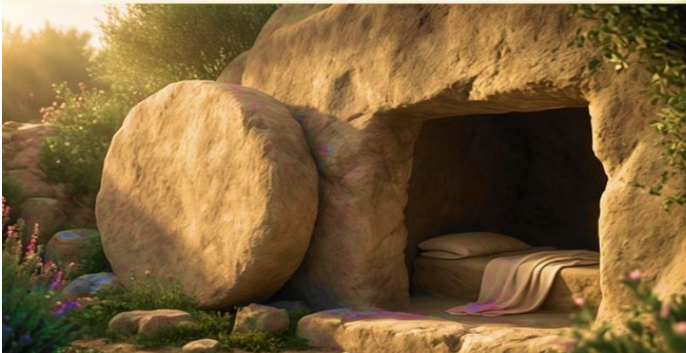
THE COVENANT



THE CRADLE



THE CROSS



THE COMFORTER



Created By: Dr. D Brown

4 C's of Christianity | Adult Edition

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Holiday Series

Adult Edition

Theme:

4 Cs of Christianity

The Covenant, The Cradle, The Cross, and The Comforter

“...I will in no way leave you, neither will I in any way forsake you.”

— Hebrews 13:5b (WEB)

COPYRIGHT

Soul Food Series – Bible Study Workbook © 2025
Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown, MBAE, MSIT, DD. All rights reserved.
Published by:
Overflow Harvest, LLC Springfield, Massachusetts, USA

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means—electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise—without prior written permission of the publisher, except as permitted by United States copyright law.

Soul Food Series and all related content, designs, and lesson formats are trademarks or service marks of Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown and are used under exclusive license through Overflow Harvest, LLC.

Usage for Churches & Small Groups

Churches and ministries are encouraged to purchase one workbook per participant whenever possible, to honor the labor and resources invested in this project. Permission is granted to reproduce brief excerpts (such as a single activity page, lesson question set, or prayer) for classroom or church use provided that:

- No fee is charged for the reproduced pages, and
- The following credit is included:
"Excerpted from the Soul Food Series by Dr. Shefa 'Dee' Brown. Used with permission."

Scripture Credits

Unless otherwise indicated, all Scripture quotations are taken from the *World English Bible* (WEB), which is in the public domain.

Disclaimer

This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

First Edition: 2025
ISBN (print): 979-8-9940733-0-8
DIGITAL (pdf): 979-8-9940733-1-5
Printed in the United States of America

DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ, the Living Word and true Bread of Life. May every page point back to Him.

To every hungry heart that has ever sat in a pew, at a kitchen table, on a lunch break, or in a quiet corner whispering, “Lord, I want to understand Your Word, but I don’t know where to start”—these lessons were written with you in mind. You are not invisible to God, and you are not too late for His promises.

To the intercessors, pastors, teachers, and destiny helpers who labor in prayer and service behind the scenes: your obedience, your “yes,” and your unseen sacrifices are the soil this work has grown from. May God reward you in ways no book could ever fully acknowledge.

And to every believer who has ever felt like “leftovers on the table of life,” may you discover through these pages that in God’s Kingdom you are never an afterthought. You are the guest of honor at a table He prepared just for you.

With love and gratitude,

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people work best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + CST (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability. Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as openers to review the previous lesson or as closers to reinforce the current one. Let youth or emerging leaders help read questions, track scores, or lead a round to build ownership and confidence.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just have to be willing, teachable, and available. God will take care of the rest.

PROLOGUE

“The Foundation of Faith”

In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whispers always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-S. L. Doctor

TABLE OF CONTENTS

.....	1
4 Cs of Christianity.....	3
The Covenant, The Cradle, The Cross, and The Comforter.....	3
COPYRIGHT.....	4
DEDICATION.....	5
QUICK START FOR LEADERS.....	6
PROLOGUE.....	7
“The Foundation of Faith”.....	7
TABLE OF CONTENTS.....	8
INTRODUCTION.....	12
“Why the 4 Cs Matter”.....	12
Why We Use the World English Bible (WEB).....	12
Lesson 1 — The Covenant.....	13
God Keeps His Promises.....	13
Appetizer — Promises He Remembers, Luke 1:72–73.....	13
Main Course.....	13
Bite 1 — God Starts the Story, Gen 15:5–6.....	13
Bite 2 — The Covenant Expands, Jer 31:31–32a.....	14
Bite 3 — The Legacy, the Laugh, and the Life, Gen 17:5,17; Gen 18:2,14.....	14
Bite 4 — Promise Fulfilled in Christ, Matt 1:1; Gal 3:16.....	14
Dessert — Yes and Amen, 2 Cor 1:20.....	15
Activity — Fill in the Blanks.....	15
Lesson 2 — The Cradle:.....	17
God Comes to Be with Us.....	17
Appetizer — The “High Point” In the Low place, Luke 2:7.....	17
Main Course.....	17
Bite 1 — Immanuel: God with Us, Matt 1:18,23.....	17
Bite 2 — The Word Became Flesh, John 1:14.....	18
Bite 3 — The Humble King, Philippians 2:6–8a.....	18
Dessert — Intentional Savior, Micah 5:2.....	18
Activity — “Cradle Connections” (Matching Game).....	19
Lesson 3: The CROSS.....	21

God Provides Salvation.....	21
Appetizer — Sacrifices That Cost, John 3:16.....	21
Main Course.....	21
Bite 1 — Affliction that vertebrated through time Isa 53:4–6.....	21
Bite 2 — He Carried Our Sin, 1 Pet 2:24.....	22
Bite 3 — “It Is Finished”, Rom 5:8.....	22
Dessert — The End Justified the Means, Phil 2:8-10.....	23
To-Go Box.....	23
Prayer.....	23
Activity – “Cross Connection” (Matching).....	24
Lesson 4— The Comforter:.....	25
God Remains with Us.....	25
Appetizer — Not Left Alone, John 14:16-18.....	25
Main Course.....	25
Bite 1 – Wait, Help is One prayer Away, Acts 1:4,8 John 14:26.....	25
Bite 2 – The Spirit Produces fruit, Gal 5:22-23.....	26
Bite 3 –Helper in our Weakness: Rom 8:26-27.....	26
Dessert – Intercessor, You’re Not Alone, John 16:13.....	27
Word Study – Paraklētos (Comforter / Counselor).....	27
To-Go Box – This Week’s Take-Home.....	28
Short Prayer	28
Bonus Lessons Overview.....	31
Names of God, Numbers and Seasons.....	31
Lesson 5: The Names of God.....	33
Understanding the Sacred Language.....	33
Appetizer – A Sacred Introduction.....	33
Main Course – Understanding the Divine Names and Titles.....	33
Bite 1 – YHWH (יהוה) – The Self-Existent One, Ex 3:14–15.....	33
Bite 2 – Yeshua HaMashiach (ישוע המשיח), Matt 1:21.....	34
Bite 3 – Ruach HaKodesh (רוח הקדש) – The Holy Spirit, Ps 51:11.....	34
Bite 4 – YHWH Lammēd (יהוה למד)-The Lord Our Teacher, Isa 48:17.....	34
Bite 5 – Selah (סֵלָה), Reflect, Ps 3:4.....	34
Bite 6 – Amen (אָמֵן), 2 Cor 1:20.....	35
Bite 7 – Hallelujah (הלל־יה), Ps 150:1.....	35
Bite 8 – The True Vine, John 15:1.....	35

Bite 9 – The Son of God, Matt 16:16 (WEB).....	35
Dessert – What you need–He is, Isaiah 9:6 (WEB).....	35
Activity – Fill in the Blank.....	36
Word Study.....	36
Lesson 6— Times and Seasons:.....	38
God’s Order in Days and Numbers.....	38
Appetizer – Methodical Seasons, Genesis 8:22 (WEB).....	38
Main Course.....	38
Bite 1 – Numbers sand the Candence of Eternity, Gen 1:14.....	38
Bite 2 — Calendar, Seasons and Feasts, Lev 23:2.....	39
Dessert – God’s Timing, Leviticus 25:10(WEB).....	40
Activity – Match the Meaning.....	40
Word Study.....	40
Prayer.....	41
Offline Playable Games	42
SOFU Passport Trek (Stamp Game).....	42
GRinCH (GRid IroN CHallenge) Game.....	42
Master Tracker (PTG).....	44
Master Tracker (GRinCH).....	46
The Grid Grind Challenge.....	47
.....	48
Grid Iron Card A-1.....	48
Grid Iron Card A-2.....	49
Grid Iron Card B-1.....	50
Grid Iron Card B-2.....	51
.....	52
Grid Iron Card C.....	52
Grid Iron Card C-2.....	53
Holiday Edition – AE Activity Answer Key Appendix.....	54
Lesson 1 — THE COVENANT (AE).....	54
Lesson 2 — THE CRADLE (AE).....	54
Lesson 3 — THE CROSS (AE).....	54
Lesson 4 — THE COMFORTER (AE).....	54
Bonus Lesson — Youth Names of God (Answer Key).....	55
Bonus Lesson — TIMES & SEASONS (Answer Key).....	55

CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGMENTS.....56

All scriptures are from the World English Bible (WEB) unless otherwise noted.



INTRODUCTION

“Why the 4 Cs Matter”

The Covenant, the Cradle, the Cross, and the Comforter

There’s something powerful about walking through the story of Jesus on purpose, not just on holidays. The Covenant, the Cradle, the Cross, and the Comforter are more than church words—they are mile markers in the story of our faith.

The Covenant reminds us that God started this long before we showed up. He found a man with a barren wife and dared them to believe that nations would be blessed through their “yes.” The Cradle shows us that promise wrapped in cloth—God in a manger, Heaven touching earth in the most unlikely place. But we can’t get stuck at the baby in the straw. The Cross reveals the weight of that promise fulfilled: the sinless One taking on sin, death, and the grave so we could call on Abba Father with boldness and access.

And when Jesus ascended, He didn’t leave us alone, but He sent the Comforter—the Holy Spirit, the third Person of the Godhead—to walk with us, live in us, and empower us to share the Good News. In the Garden of Gethsemane, Jesus said, “Not My will, but Yours be done,” and because of that surrendered “yes,” we now have the right to pray, to petition, and to partner with God in His work on earth.

The 4Cs are not just a Christmas theme; they are a blueprint for how we live. They remind us that God plans, God comes, God saves, and God stays. As you walk through these lessons, let them stir your faith beyond a calendar month. Our prayer is that you’ll be encouraged, equipped, and excited to tell someone else just how great our God is—because the harvest is still plentiful, and the laborers are still needed.

Why We Use the World English Bible (WEB)

In this series, our primary "Main Course" is served using the **World English Bible (WEB)**. You may be accustomed to hearing the **King James Version (KJV)**, **New International Version (NIV)**, **New Living Translation (NLT)**, **New King James Version (NKJV)**, or **The Message (MSG)** in your weekly services. While those are excellent for corporate worship, we have strategically chosen the WEB for this study for three specific reasons:

1. **Modern Clarity:** Like other modern versions you hear in church, the WEB uses clear, contemporary English. This removes the linguistic barriers of the KJV, making the Word easy to digest for students of all ages.
2. **Restoration of the Name:** Unique among modern versions, the WEB restores the proper, covenant name of God—**Yahweh**—in the Old Testament. This allows us to study the *Names of God* exactly as they were intended to be revealed in the original text.
3. **The Unfettered Word:** Most modern translations are strictly governed by copyright law. Because the WEB is in the **Public Domain**, it is "unfettered." This allows us to share, print, and teach these lessons freely, ensuring the Word is never hindered by legal or licensing restrictions.

Our Recommendation: We encourage you to keep your favorite study Bibles—such as the Complete Jewish Bible (CJB), the Tree of Life Version (TLV), or the Names of God Bible (NOG)—nearby. Comparing the modern clarity of the WEB with the Hebraic depth of these other versions will give you a full, 360-degree view of God’s character.

Lesson 1 — The Covenant

God Keeps His Promises

Theme: The Promise Still Stands

Background Text: Gen 12:1–3; Gen 15:5–6; Gen 17:5,17, Gen 18:2,14; Jer 31:31–34; Gal 3:16; Lk 1:72–73; 2 Cor 1:20

Key Verse: Genesis 12:1–3 (WEB)

¹Now Yahweh said to Abram, “Leave your country, and your relatives, and your father’s house, and go to the land that I will show you. ²I will make of you a great nation. I will bless you and make your name great. You will be a blessing. ³I will bless those who bless you, and I will curse him who treats you with contempt. All the families of the earth will be blessed through you.”

Appetizer — Promises He Remembers, Luke 1:72–73

⁷²to show mercy toward our fathers, to remember his holy covenant, ⁷³the oath which he swore to Abraham our father.”

CST Reflection

Where in your life have you seen God make the first move toward you?

Main Course

Bite 1 — God Starts the Story, Gen 15:5–6

⁵He brought him outside, and said, “Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them.” He said to Abram, “So shall your offspring be.” ⁶He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.

God’s promises are built on His character, not human perfection. Even when Abram doubted, God remained committed. The Covenant says: “My Word is stronger than your weakness.”

Reflection Question

Why is it powerful to know that God made the first move toward us?

Bite 2 — The Covenant Expands, Jer 31:31–32a

³¹ “Behold, the days come,” says Yahweh, “that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah, ³² not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt,

This prophecy points directly to Jesus, the New Covenant, where God no longer writes on stone but on human hearts.

CST Reflection

Discuss what two covenants that God made with man before the “New Covenant”?

Bite 3 —The Legacy, the Laugh, and the Life, Gen 17:5,17; Gen 18:2,14

⁵ Your name will no more be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ¹⁷ Then Abraham fell on his face, and laughed, and said in his heart, “Will a child be born to him who is one hundred years old? Will Sarah, who is ninety years old, give birth?”

² Sarah laughed within herself, saying, “After I have grown old will I have pleasure, my lord being old also?” ¹⁴ Is anything too hard for Yahweh? At the set time I will return to you, when the season comes around, and Sarah will have a son.”

If we are frank with ourselves, sometimes promises of God seem very far away...and days turn into weeks, turn into years...years approach decades in some cases. “Not now”, feels just like “No” and Abraham and Sarah were challenged in their faith to still believe that God would follow through with his promise of an heir in the covenant that was made, since he left his family and exercise faith in believing that God’s word would hold true.

Bite 4 — Promise Fulfilled in Christ, Matt 1:1; Gal 3:16

^{1:1} The book of the genealogy of Jesus Christ,^[a] the son of David, the son of Abraham.

^{3:16} Now the promises were spoken to Abraham and to his seed.

He doesn’t say, “To seeds,” as of many, but as of one, “To your seed,” which is Christ. The world was blessed through the obedience of Abraham that helped paved the wave for the redemption of all mankind.

Reflection Question

What covenant promises do we need to remind our families of this season?

Dessert — Yes and Amen, 2 Cor 1:20

²⁰ For however many are the promises of God, in him is the “Yes.” Therefore also through him is the “Amen”, to the glory of God through us.

Jesus is the “Yes” to every promise God ever made. In Him, we see God’s reliability — steady, unfailing, unchanging.

Reflection Question

Share a moment when God proved Himself faithful in your life.

Group Conversation Questions

- What do you learn about God’s faithfulness from His covenant with Abraham?
- How does Jesus fulfill (not cancel) God’s earlier promises?
- How does knowing God keeps His Word bring peace into your daily life?

Activity — Fill in the Blanks

A covenant is a sacred, _____ agreement God initiated.

God promised Abraham that all _____ on earth would be blessed.

Jesus’ birth is the _____ of God’s ancient promise.

God’s promises stand because of His _____, not our perfection.

Word Study

- Covenant — “Berit” (בְּרִית): A binding, relational promise initiated by God.
- Yahweh (יְהוָה): The covenant name of God revealed to Moses; meaning “I AM,” the self-existent, eternal One.

To-Go Box

God made a promise.

God kept a promise.

God *still* keeps His promises.

When you cannot see the way forward, look backward at His faithfulness.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for being a promise-keeping God. Remove doubt, negative conversations, word curses, distractions and anxiousness. Help us trust Your covenant faithfulness in every season of life. Amen.”

Notes — Personal Insight

Lesson 2 — The Cradle:

God Comes to Be with Us

Theme: Heaven Came Down

Background Text: Luke 2:7; Isaiah 7:14; John 1:14; Philippians 2:6–8; Micah 5:2

Key Verse: John 1:14 (WEB)

“The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the one and only Son of the Father, full of grace and truth.”

Appetizer — The “High Point” In the Low place, Luke 2:7

⁷ She gave birth to her firstborn son. She wrapped him in bands of cloth and laid him in a feeding trough, because there was no room for them in the inn.

The cradle is more than a baby bed — it is the place where eternity stepped into time. Jesus did not arrive with parades, soldiers, palaces, or political might. He came the way most of us came: in vulnerability, wrapped in cloth, placed in a feeding trough.

CST Reflection

Where has God met you in a “low place” and revealed Himself unexpectedly?

Main Course

Bite 1 — Immanuel: God with Us, Matt 1:18,23

¹⁸ Now the birth of Jesus Christ was like this: After his mother, Mary, was engaged to Joseph, before they came together, she was found pregnant by the Holy Spirit. “Behold, the virgin shall be with child and shall give birth to a son. They shall call his name Immanuel; which is, being interpreted, ‘God with us.’”

Long before the manger, God spoke a promise: Immanuel—“God with us.” The cradle was not an accident; it was a prophecy kept on schedule. The cradle declares that God is not distant. He stepped into our world to experience life as we do. The humility of the manger shows that God meets us in low places and lifts us into relationship with Himself. The cradle begins the journey toward the cross, showing the depth of God’s love.

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you most need to remember that God is actually *with* you, not just watching from a distance?

Bite 2 — The Word Became Flesh, John 1:14

¹⁴The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the only born Son of the Father, full of grace and truth.

Immanuel - God with us...the manger was not a random scene — it was a prophecy fulfilled.

God with us in:

Our fear

Our uncertainty

Our waiting

Our joy

Our brokenness

The cradle tells us: God is not distant. He is present, near, and intentional.

Bite 3 — The Humble King, Philippians 2:6–8a

⁶who, existing in the form of God, didn't consider equality with God a thing to be grasped, ⁷but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men. ⁸And being found in human form, he humbled himself

The Creator chose the crib before the crown. Before He carried the cross, He was a carpenter. This is the humility of Jesus — the King who starts His earthly story at the bottom, so no one can say He cannot relate to their struggle. His power wasn't based on how he came, but who he is and the example He provided for us to work towards.

Reflection Questions

Why do you think God chose a baby and not a whole warrior king?

Dessert – Intentional Savior, Micah 5:2

²But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, being small among the clans of Judah, out of you one will come out to me who is to be ruler in Israel; whose goings out are from of old, from ancient times.

His birth was personal — *born to you*. The cradle reminds us that hope is not an idea; hope is a person. Our intentional Savior.

CST Reflection

How does the birth of Jesus change the way you see your own worth or your own story?

Group Discussion:

When has God stepped into a low moment in your life and showed up strong?

Activity — “Cradle Connections” (Matching Game)

Match the truth to the scripture:

- | | |
|---|---------------------------|
| A. God with us (Emmanuel promised) | Isaiah 7:14 → _____ |
| B. Jesus’ humble birth | Luke 2:7 → _____ |
| C. The Word became flesh | Philippians 2:6–8 → _____ |
| D. The Humble King (He emptied Himself) | John 1:14 → _____ |

Word Study

Immanuel (עִמָּנוּאֵל): “God with us” — God choosing closeness, not distance.

Cradle/Manger: A feeding trough — symbolizing humility, provision, and God meeting us where we are.

To-Go Box

Jesus didn’t wait for the world to be perfect — He stepped into it as it was.

The imperfect world, needed a perfect savior

The cradle reminds us:

God shows up in ordinary places to do extraordinary things.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for sending Jesus to dwell among us. You remind us that your grace is extended to us even in our lowest of lows. You recognized that the greatest thing in that moment is that you arrived, with purpose and promise. Help us embrace Your presence and share Your love with others. Amen.”

Notes —Personal Insight

Lesson 3: The CROSS

God Provides Salvation

Theme: Grieving Grace → Redeeming Grace

Background Text: Isa 53:4–6; John 3:16, 19:17–30; 1 Pet 2:24; Rom 5:8

Key Verse — John 19:30 (WEB)

“When Jesus therefore had received the vinegar, He said, ‘**It is finished.**’ He bowed His head, and gave up His spirit.”

Appetizer — Sacrifices That Cost, John 3:16

¹⁶ For God so loved the world, that he gave his only born Son, that whoever believes in him should not perish, but have eternal life.

When most people see a cross during the holidays, they think of Easter, not *Christmas*. But the truth is this:

The cradle only matters because of the cross.

Before Mary ever held the baby, Heaven already saw the sacrifice. The birth was only the beginning, Jesus came **with a mission** — not only to be born, but to **save**. And the cost of sin is death, so when people say you were ‘bought with a price’, they are referring to this moment...where Emmanuel or Jesus the Christ stepped out of his divine power and subjected himself to death...

CST Reflection

What does the cross mean to *you* personally when you see it during the holiday season?

Main Course

Bite 1 — Affliction that vertebrated through time Isa 53:4–6

⁴ Surely he has borne our sicknesses and carried our sufferings; yet we considered him plagued, struck by God, and afflicted. ⁵ But he was pierced for our transgressions. He was crushed for our iniquities. The punishment that brought our peace was on him; and by his wounds we are healed.

⁶ All we like sheep have gone astray. Everyone has turned to his own way; and Yahweh has laid on him the iniquity of us all.

Isaiah saw Calvary long before it happened. He saw the beating, the piercing, the grief, and the glory. Christ went through what we could not so he could bring us back to God the Father. So, when you remember the cross, remember this: redemption was not an afterthought—God planned our rescue, and Jesus paid the price in full.

Atonement means Jesus carried what should've been carried by us. He took the full weight of sin so we wouldn't have to.

Reflections

Write one area in your life where you need to remember that “He carried it.”

Bite 2 — He Carried Our Sin, 1 Pet 2:24

(WEB) ²⁴He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we, having died to sins, might live to righteousness. You were healed by his wounds.

He Himself bore our sins in His body on the tree... by whose stripes you were healed.

The cross shows both:

The seriousness of sin, and the magnitude of God's love.

Jesus didn't die because we were behaving well...

He died because we needed Him.

Grace does not ignore sin —

Grace pays for it.

Reflection Question

What does Jesus' sacrifice teach you about your value to God?

Bite 3 — “It Is Finished”, Rom 5:8

⁸ But God commends his own love toward us, in that while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.

“It is finished” is not a sign of defeat — It is Heaven's victory shout.

The debt is paid.

The curse is broken.

The Redeemer has won.

Salvation is secured.

The cross is the turning point of all humanity.

Reflection

How does “It is finished” strengthen you in the battles you still face today?

Dessert — The End Justified the Means, Phil 2:8-10

(WEB) ⁸ And being found in human form, he humbled himself, becoming obedient to the point of death, yes, the death of the cross. ⁹ Therefore God also highly exalted him, and gave to him the name which is above every name, ¹⁰ that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of those in heaven, those on earth, and those under the earth,

He didn’t wait for us to be perfect. He didn’t wait for us to “get it together.” He loved first — fully, fiercely, and forever. Christ was the “World’s scapegoat” because he submitted to the law of Sin and Death.. but since he was ‘Not Guilty’ the Hell held no legal ground to hold him. Glory Hallelujah to the Lamb that was Slain.

Reflection

Write one sentence of gratitude for the cross.

To-Go Box

- The **cradle** introduced Jesus.
- The **cross** fulfilled His mission.
- Salvation is a **gift**, not wages.
- Grace is not earned — it is received.
- The cross proves you are loved more deeply than you know.

Carry this truth into every season:

Jesus paid it all... joyfully.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, thank You for the cross and for loving us enough to lay down Your life. Thank You for carrying every burden, healing every wound, and opening the door to salvation. Help us walk in gratitude, humility, and obedience as we reflect on Your sacrifice. Amen.”

Group Reflection Questions

1. What does the cross personally mean to you as a person walking with Christ?
2. How does “It is finished” give you strength in life’s battles?

Activity – “Cross Connection” (Matching)

Terms

Meanings

A. Atonement	_____ 1. “Paid in full”; Jesus’ victory declaration
B. Redemption	_____ 2. Being bought back by Christ
C. Love	_____ 3. Jesus paying for our sins
D. “It is finished.”	_____ 4. God’s motivation for the cross

(Check the Appendix for the answers.)

Notes Section—Personal Study

Lesson 4— The Comforter:

God Remains with Us

Theme: The Holy Spirit is our Comforter, Advocate, and Teacher.

Background Text: John 14:15–27; Acts 1:1–8; Rom 8:18–27; Gal 5:16–25; John 16:7–15

Key Verse: John 14:26(WEB)

“But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.”

Appetizer — Not Left Alone, John 14:16-18

¹⁶I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, ^[a] that he may be with you forever: ¹⁷the Spirit of truth, whom the world can't receive, for it doesn't see him and doesn't know him. You know him, for he lives with you and will be in you.

Holidays and quiet seasons can magnify loneliness. People move, loved ones pass away, families change, and routines shift, but Jesus' promise doesn't shift with them. He promises that we will never be spiritual orphans—the Holy Spirit is God's abiding presence within us.

Main Course

Bite 1 – Wait, Help is One prayer Away, Acts 1:4,8 John 14:26

^{1:4}Being assembled together with them, he commanded them, “Don't depart from Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the Father, which you heard from me. ⁸But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you. You will be witnesses to me in Jerusalem, in all Judea and Samaria, and to the uttermost parts of the earth.”

^{14:26} But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things, and will remind you of all that I said to you.

After the resurrection and ascension, Jesus did not leave us alone. The Comforter—the Holy Spirit—arrived as God's presence within us, guiding, strengthening, and **empowering believers**.

Table Talk

1. When you feel most alone, what do you usually reach for—people, distractions, or prayer?
-

Bite 2 – The Spirit Produces fruit, Gal 5:22-23

²² But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith,^[a] ²³ gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.

The Spirit doesn't just give goosebumps; He grows fruit. Over time, His presence shows up as love instead of bitterness, peace instead of panic, and self-control instead of out-of-control reactions. The real evidence that the Comforter is with us is not just how we *feel* but how we *live*.

The Holy Spirit's presence is not just to comfort us in private; it empowers us in public. The Spirit brings to light the evidence of a changed life. Comfort doesn't mean an escape from assignment—often it means strength *for* the assignment.

CST Prompt

Finish this sentence in your own words:

“If the Holy Spirit is my power, then I don't have to rely on _____ when God asks me to speak or serve.”

Bite 3 –Helper in our Weakness: Rom 8:26-27

²⁶ In the same way, the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, for we don't know how to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself makes intercession for us with groanings which can't be uttered. ²⁷ He who searches the hearts knows what is on the Spirit's mind, because he makes intercession for the saints according to God.

Author's Testimony

I was going through “Battle Stations” while in Navy Bootcamp and we had to go on one part of the course in gas masks and protective gear. It felt suffocating and uncomfortable and to make it more challenging we were given a 150lbs dummy that we had to push and pull up a rope the height of one story! The recruit that was ahead of me wanted to give up. So, I had the weight of her and the dummy pressing down on me while I held on with all that I had. I pleaded to God for help and tried to encourage her not to quit! My mind wanted to not to quit but my body was pushed to its limits...

Sometimes the weight of the world (figuratively) bears down on you. Your body is tired, emotionally you are spent but you must embrace His strength in your weakness to make it through.

Reflection

Write 2–3 sentences:

How does knowing the Spirit is “with you and in you” shift the way you see hard seasons, empty rooms, or silent nights?

Dessert – Intercessor, You’re Not Alone, John 16:13

¹³ However, when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming.

The same Jesus who walked beside His disciples sent the Spirit to walk *inside* us. We may sit at empty tables, move into new cities, or face seasons where people let us down—but we are never spiritually abandoned. The Comforter makes “God with us” a daily reality, not just a Christmas slogan.

Reflection Questions

1. Think of a time when you *felt* alone but, looking back, you can see God was holding you. What signs of His presence do you see now?

2. How might your daily routine change if you really believed the Holy Spirit is always with you and in you?

Word Study – Paraklētōs (Comforter / Counselor)

- **Literal Sense:** “One called alongside,” especially to help, advocate, or defend.
- **Ruach HaKodesh:** Holy Spirit; “Breath of God.”
- **Empower:** To equip and strengthen for a divine purpose.
- **Witness:** One who testifies to truth through word and life.
- **Indwelling** – The Holy Spirit actually living in believers, not just visiting.
- **Fruit of the Spirit** – The visible evidence of the Holy Spirit’s work in a believer’s character and behavior.

To-Go Box – This Week’s Take-Home

Choose at least **one**:

- **Talk to Him Daily:** Start each morning this week with:
“Holy Spirit, I welcome You. Lead me, comfort me, and guide me today.”
 - **Pause Before Reacting:** When you feel triggered, whisper,
“Comforter, help me respond in the Spirit, not in my flesh.”
 - **Fruit Check:** Pick one fruit of the Spirit (love, peace, patience, etc.) and intentionally practice it in a difficult relationship or setting.
-

Short Prayer

“Holy Spirit, thank You for being my Comforter and Helper. Fill me again with Your presence. Grow Your fruit in my life—love, joy, peace, and all the rest. Help me remember I am never alone when You are with me. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

THE DIVINE NAMES: TIMES & SEASONS

A Spiritual Journey Through God's Names



Bonus Lessons Overview

Names of God, Numbers and Seasons

In church, we sing and shout about Jehovah Jireh, Jehovah Shalom, Elohim, and El Shaddai—but sometimes we don’t slow down long enough to ask, “What does that really mean?” This bonus “Bible Basics” section is designed to help you connect the dots: the names of God, the meaning behind numbers like 3, 7, and 40, the harvest seasons, and phrases like “the Year of Jubilee.”

God is not distant and generic; He is personal and specific. Think about it this way: my grandmother’s name was Pearl—but depending on your relationship with her, you might have known her as Mama, Mommy, Evangelist, Pastor, Dollie, or Sis. Same woman, different roles, different levels of closeness. In the same way, God is YHWH, Elohim, Abba Father, the God who Heals, our Provider, our Peace, our banner, our righteousness. The more we walk with Him, the more we learn how to call Him by what He has been in our lives.

God is about relationship, not just ritual. He invites us to worship Him in spirit and in truth. So here’s the challenge: What is *your* truth, and what is *the* Truth? How do you really see God—and how does His Word say He truly is? These studies are an invitation to move beyond a “genie in a bottle” view of God and into a deeper, honest, grown-up conversation with your Heavenly Father. He hears. He sees. He knows.

As you explore His names, His patterns, and His appointed times, use this section as a guide—not to impress people, but to deepen your encounters with God. Take notes, ask questions, look up the scriptures, and then talk to Him about what you discover. This is about going deeper and higher in Him, one page at a time.

Lesson 5: The Names of God

Understanding the Sacred Language

Theme: Foundations of Faith

Background Text: Ex 3:13–15; Isa 9:6; John 1:1–3; Isa 48:17

Key Verse: Exodus 3:14 (WEB)

¹⁴ God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’”

Appetizer – A Sacred Introduction

The names of God are not random titles; they reveal His identity, power, and relationship with His people. Ancient Hebrews held the Name in such high reverence that it was never spoken aloud; instead, they used *Adonai* (Lord) or wrote "G-d"—omitting the vowel to honor His sacredness.

To better understand these names in their original context, translations such as the Complete Jewish Bible, the Names of God Bible, the Tree of Life Version, and the Orthodox Jewish Bible offer a deeper perspective. While the World English Bible (WEB) restores the name *Yahweh*, using it alongside these other versions provides a much fuller view of God’s character and attributes as they are revealed throughout the course of the Scriptures.

CST Reflection → How do you show reverence when speaking about or to God?

Main Course – Understanding the Divine Names and Titles

Bite 1 – YHWH (יהוה) – The Self-Existent One, Ex 3:14–15

God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’” God said moreover to Moses, “You shall tell the children of Israel this, ‘Yahweh, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you.’ This is my name forever, and this is my memorial to all generations.”

The personal name God revealed to Moses is represented by the four Hebrew letters *Yod-Hey-Vav-Hey* (YHWH). Because Hebrew originally had **no vowels**, the name was considered unutterable.

Later, scholars inserted the vowels from *Adonai* to form *YaHoVaH* — eventually becoming **Jehovah** in English.

Bite 2 – Yeshua HaMashiach (יֵשׁוּעַ הַמָּשִׁיחַ), Matt 1:21

“²¹ She shall give birth to a son. You shall name him Jesus, for it is he who shall save his people from their sins.”

Yeshua means “*Yahweh saves.*”

The English “Jesus Christ” is really “**Jesus the Christ**” — or *Yeshua the Anointed One*.

“Christ” (*Christos*) and “Messiah” (*Mashiach*) are the same title in two languages — both mean “Anointed.”

CST Reflection

Does understanding His Hebrew name deepen your faith in His mission?

Bite 3 – Ruach HaKodesh (רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ) – The Holy Spirit, Ps 51:11

Don’t throw me from your presence, and don’t take your Holy Spirit from me.
(Literally “The Holy Breath.”)

The word *Ruach* means “breath,” “wind,” or “spirit.” It signifies the **living presence of God** breathing life, comfort, and conviction into His people.

CST Reflection → What areas of your life need the fresh wind of the Holy Spirit?

Bite 4 – YHWH Lammēd (יְהוָה לָמֵד)-The Lord Our Teacher, Isa 48:17

Yahweh, your Redeemer, the Holy One of Israel, says: “I am Yahweh your God, who teaches you to profit, who leads you by the way that you should go...”

God is not only Savior but **Teacher** — revealing truth line upon line and leading us to wisdom.

Bite 5 – Selah (סֵלָה), Reflect, Ps 3:4

(WEB) I cry to Yahweh with my voice, and he answers me out of his holy hill. Selah.

Found 74 times in the Psalms, *Selah* means “pause and reflect.” It’s a divine **rest stop** — a spiritual breath meant for meditation.

Bite 6 – Amen (אָמֵן), 2 Cor 1:20

²⁰ For however many are the promises of God, in him is the “Yes.” Therefore also through him is the “Amen”, to the glory of God through us.

From *aman* — “to confirm, to be faithful.” (root verb form of amen)

When we say “Amen,” we declare **“Let it be so”** — aligning our agreement with God’s word. Your “amens” are affirming that word, that statement which is being spoken or sung.

Bite 7 – Hallelujah (הללוֹיָהּ), Ps 150:1

Praise Yah! Praise God in his sanctuary! Praise him in his heavens for his acts of power!

A compound of *Hallel* (praise) + *Yah* (short for YHWH).

Meaning **“Praise the Lord!”** — it is the same in nearly every language, uniting all believers in worship. It is a command to praise God, though often people are found declaring it as the “highest praise” which is not the actual translation. When someone says Hallelujah, is an INVITATION to worship and uplift the name of God - Yah !

Bite 8 – The True Vine, John 15:1

“I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer.”

Yeshua identifies Himself as the source of life — the one through whom believers bear fruit.

Bite 9 – The Son of God, Matt 16:16 (WEB)

Simon Peter answered, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.”

This title declares both His **divinity** and His **relationship** with the Father.

Dessert – What you need—He is, Isaiah 9:6 (WEB)

For a child is born to us, a son is given to us; and the government will be on His shoulders. His will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.

No matter how He is named — **YHWH, Yeshua, Ruach HaKodesh, or Abba** — His nature remains one: holy, eternal, and faithful.

CST Reflection →

Which name(s) of God speaks most to your current need or revelation? Discuss answers in group.

Reflection Questions

1. How does *Yeshua HaMashiach* deepen your understanding of salvation?

2. What

does *Ruach HaKodesh* reveal about God's closeness to His people?

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. There is no letter _____ in the Hebrew alphabet.
2. The name *Yeshua* means “_____ saves.”
3. The Holy Spirit in Hebrew is called “_____ HaKodesh.”
4. *Selah* means “_____.”
5. *Amen* means “_____.”

Word Study

Term	Language	Meaning
YHWH (יהוה)	Hebrew	“I AM” – Self-existent One
Yeshua (ישוע)	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yahweh Saves
Ruach HaKodesh (רוח הקדש)	Hebrew	Holy Spirit / Breath of God
YHWH Lammēd (יהוה למד)	Hebrew	The Lord Our Teacher
Selah (סֶלָה)	Hebrew	Pause and Reflect
Amen (אָמֵן)	Hebrew	Let It Be So / Truly
Hallelujah (הללו־יָה)	Hebrew	Praise the Lord
Abba (אָבָא)	Aramaic	Father / Intimate One
Mashiach (מָשִׁיחַ)	Hebrew	Anointed One
Emmanuel (עִמָּנוּאֵל)	Hebrew	God With Us

Covenant Name / Title	Meaning	Scripture
YHWH Jireh (Jehovah Jireh)	The LORD Will Provide	Genesis 22:14
YHWH Rapha (Jehovah Rapha)	The LORD Who Heals	Exodus 15:26
YHWH Shalom (Jehovah Shalom)	The LORD Is Peace	Judges 6:24
YHWH Nissi (Jehovah Nissi)	The LORD Is My Banner/Victory	Exodus 17:15
YHWH Rohi (Jehovah Rohi)	The LORD My Shepherd	Psalms 23:1
YHWH Tsidkenu (Jehovah Tsidkenu)	The LORD Our Righteousness	Jeremiah 23:6
YHWH Shammah (Jehovah Shammah)	The LORD Is There (Present)	Ezekiel 48:35
YHWH Mekoddishkem (Jehovah M'kaddesh)	The LORD Who Sanctifies	Leviticus 20:8
YHWH Sabaoth (LORD of Hosts)	Commander of Heaven's Armies	1 Samuel 1:3

Historical Sidebar

Language Stage	Rendering of Jesus' Name	Approx. Century
Hebrew	Yeshua (יֵשׁוּעַ)	Before 1st Century
Greek	Iesous (Ἰησοῦς)	1st Century
Latin	Iesus	4th Century
English	Jesus	16th Century

The letter *J* evolved from the letter *I*, first appearing in print around 1524.

Jewish scribes avoided writing God's full name to prevent misuse — hence *G-d*

Prayer – (Applying His character to our petition)

Abba Father,

You are the I am that I am, Elohim we adore you, we thank you for showing us just how awesome you are. We appreciate you sending Yeshua not only to be our example but to die for us...and then in your mercy you left your Ruach to be our comfort our Lammed our Wonderful Counselor. Adonai when we have lack in our lives you are Jehovah Jirreh, the God who provides, we thank you for being the Jehovah Shalom in the midst of the chaos that we call life, and when our bodies we sick and need a healing Jehovah Rapha you are the God who heals, we thank you that healing is the children's bread and there is a balm in Gilead and we appreciate your presence, you said that when two or three gather together in your name you'd be in the midst, Holy One, El Shaddai revive us again from the crown of our heads to the very soles of our feet. Heal our heart, touch our nations and those that have rule over us, send angels unaware to be wise counsel and let your love and wisdom abide have mercy on us, and we'd be so careful to give you the praise, the honor in the glory, Hallelujah, to the One that Reigns forever and ever, amen.

Lesson 6— Times and Seasons:

God’s Order in Days and Numbers

Theme: Foundations of Faith

Background Text: Genesis 1:14 – 19; Leviticus 25:8 – 13

Key Verse: Ecclesiastes 3:1 (WEB)

³ For everything there is a season, and a time for every purpose under heaven:

Appetizer – Methodical Seasons, Genesis 8:22 (WEB)

“²² While the earth remains, seed time and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night will not cease.”

God created time, order, and rhythm—seasons that reflect His faithfulness. While we previously explored God’s names, now we begin to grasp life’s patterns—physically and spiritually—and the intricacy of God’s design. As we recognize these rhythms, we learn to trust His sovereign plan.

Main Course

Bite 1 – Numbers sand the Candence of Eternity, Gen 1:14

(WEB) ¹⁴ And God said, Let there be lights in the firmament of the heaven to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs, and for seasons, and for days, and years:

We often read Scripture and see God working through patterns—whether it’s creation, appointed feasts, or periods of trial. These numbers and seasons aren’t superstitions—they reflect God’s order and purpose, reminding us to trust His timing. As we explore these patterns, we learn to see God’s hand in every season of life.

Now, let’s look at a simple table of key biblical numbers. Each entry offers a scriptural reference and a brief meaning—a starting point for deeper study.

Number	Meaning	Scripture Example
1	Unity; Beginning	Deuteronomy 6:4
2	Witness; Agreement	Matthew 18:19
3	Divine Completeness	Matthew 28:19
4	Creation; Divine Order	Revelation 7:1
5	Grace	Genesis 43:34
6	Man; Labor	Revelation 13:18
7	Completion; Rest	Genesis 2:2
8	New Beginnings	2 Peter 2:5

9	Fruitfulness; Judgment	Galatians 5:22
10	Law; Responsibility	Exodus 20:1–17
12	Government; Authority	Revelation 21:12
40	Testing / Transition	Matthew 4:2
50	Jubilee; Freedom	Leviticus 25:10
666	Number of the Beast	Rev 13:18

Bite 2 — Calendar, Seasons and Feasts, Lev 23:2

(WEB) Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘The set feasts of Yahweh, which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my set feasts.’

In Western culture, we often think of a day as sunrise to sunrise. In biblical Jewish culture, a day is often counted from sunset to sunset. That’s why many Jewish holidays begin at sundown. It’s a reminder that God can start something new in what looks like “night.”

Associating biblical times, seasons, and celebrations with our calendar helps bring the Word to life—because God is not only the God of “back then,” but the God of right now. As you look at the months and cycles, notice how God keeps repeating the same message: freedom, formation, repentance, and renewal.

Jewish Month	Gregorian Equivalent	Primary Focus / Festival
1. Nisan	March / April	Passover, Unleavened Bread, First fruits
2. Iyar	April / May	Counting the Omer
3. Sivan	May / June	Shavuot (Pentecost / Giving of the Law)
4. Tammuz	June / July	Fast of the 17th of Tammuz
5. Av	July / August	Tisha B'Av (Temple remembrance)
6. Elul	August / September	Repentance / Preparation for Rosh Hashanah
7. Tishrei	September / October	Rosh Hashanah, Yom Kippur, Sukkot
8. Cheshvan	October / November	A “quiet” month (no major feasts)
9. Kislev	November / December	Hanukkah (Feast of Dedication)
10. Tevet	December / January	Fast of the 10th of Tevet
11. Shevat	January / February	Tu B'Shevat (New Year for Trees)
12. Adar	February / March	Purim (Esther’s victory)

Note: Tishrei (September/October) begins the civil year with Rosh Hashanah. In some leap years on the Hebrew calendar, an extra month is added to keep the lunar cycle aligned with the solar seasons.

Season (Cycle)	Key Holidays / Observances	Scripture Reference (examples)
Spring: Redemption	Passover + Unleavened Bread	Exodus 12; Leviticus 23
Late Spring / Early Summer: Covenant & Harvest	Shavuot (Feast of Weeks)	Leviticus 23; Deuteronomy 16
Summer: Reflection	A season of reflection and remembrance	Psalms 90:12 ("count our days")
Fall: Repentance & Ingathering	Trumpets / Atonement / Tabernacles themes	Leviticus 23
Winter: Dedication / Light	Feast of Dedication (Hanukkah) themes	John 10:22
Late Winter / Early Spring: Turning / Joy	Purim (deliverance)	Esther 9
Land-Cycle (multi-year)	Sabbath year & Jubilee patterns	Leviticus 25

Dessert – God’s Timing, Leviticus 25:10(WEB)

¹⁰ You shall make the fiftieth year holy, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee to you; and each of you shall return to his own property, and each of you shall return to his family.

God’s timing always leads to freedom — not fatigue.

CST Reflection →

How has God reset your seasons recently?

Activity – Match the Meaning

1. **50** – _____ A. New Beginning
2. **7** – _____ B. Witness
3. **8** – _____ C. Completion
4. **2** – _____ D. Year of Jubilee

Word Study

- *Mo'ed* (מוֹעֵד) — appointed time / season
- Shabbat (שַׁבָּת) — rest

Prayer

Holy Spirit, thank You for Your steady presence—my Comforter, Counselor, and Helper. Please fill me anew and align my heart with God’s will. Grow Your fruit in my life—love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control. Strengthen me to walk in wisdom, respond in grace, and remain anchored in truth. Remind me that I am never alone, because You abide with me.

In Jesus’ name, amen.

Notes Section—Personal Study

Printing out the tables for quick reference for personal study or devotion is encouraged.



Offline Playable Games



SOFU Passport Trek (Stamp Game)

Passport Trek is a progression-style game where each participant (or team) “travels” through SOFU content and earns stamps as they complete categories/lesson and levels (COV, CRA, CRO, COM, NOG, TS). It works beautifully for workshops, youth groups, retreats, and instructor-led cohorts because learners can *see* their progress as they move from Level 1 to Level 3. Use the **Master Tracker** to record stamps/levels earned across sessions—either per individual or per team. **Copies of the offline boards and trackers may be made for dissemination for in-person use.**

For gameplay, you can run it **solo** (personal growth + accountability) or in **teams of 2–3** (high engagement, easy to manage). A strong event format is a playoff-style tournament: use **three brackets** that lead into a final round, with knockout advancement based on correct answers, completion, or point totals. This format keeps the room moving, prevents long wait times, and makes it simple to run multiple rounds without heavy materials. **Medallions like the logos seen can be earned in group play, if purchased for team play/tournaments.**

GRinCH (GRid IRon CHallenge) Game

GRinCH is a fast-paced grid-board challenge designed for review, recall, and teamwork. Instructors call a **number (“Counting Your Days”)**, teams locate the matching square on their GRinCH cards (now **1A/B, 2A/B, 3A/B**), then respond quickly to earn credit. When a team completes the win condition, they call out **“GRinCH!”** to signal a verified win.

You can also run a “Black Out” mode: teams must complete and correctly validate **all** required answers—then they call **“Nailed it!”** (a fun nod to “Jesus paid it all”). For capturing answers, the most economical option is paper; the most reusable/eco-friendly is **small dry erase boards, chalkboards, or flip charts**. These methods reduce confusion, let you verify responses quickly, and make it easier to award points for both **accuracy** and **speed**. Copies of the offline boards may be made for dissemination for in-person use, and the **Master Tracker** can be used to record wins and progress by player or team.

Category tags:

COV = Covenant | CRA = Cradle | CRO = Cross | COM = Comforter | NOG = Names of God | TS = Numbers/Times/Seasons



Game 1 — HOL Passport Challenge (Stamp Race)

Time: 15–25min. | Players: 1–6 (solo or teams) | Goal: earn all 6 stamps.

How it works: Complete each challenge. When you finish, fill in the stamp box for that lesson. (Handout next page)

THE COVENANT Stamp: _____	THE CRADLE Stamp: _____	THE CROSS Stamp: _____
THE COMFORTER Stamp: _____	NAMES OF GOD Stamp: _____	TIMES & SEASONS Stamp: _____

Challenges (complete all 6):

1. **Covenant:** Read Genesis 12:1–3. In 1–2 sentences: What promise did God make, and what does it teach you about God’s faithfulness?
2. **Cradle:** Read Luke 2:7 and Matthew 1:23. In 1 sentence: What does “Immanuel” mean, and why does it matter?
3. **Cross:** Read John 3:16 and Romans 5:8. In 1–2 sentences: What did Jesus do for us, and what should our response be?
4. **Comforter:** Read John 14:18 and Acts 1:8. Name one way the Holy Spirit helps believers, and one “fruit” you want God to grow in you (Galatians 5:22–23).
5. **Names of God:** Choose one name/title from the lesson (YHWH, Yeshua, Ruach HaKodesh, Abba, etc.). Write: When I feel _____, God is _____ because _____.
6. **Numbers, Times & Seasons:** Read Ecclesiastes 3:1 and Psalm 90:12 (“count our days”). Choose a season word (planting, waiting, pruning, harvest) and write one wise step you can take this week.



Master Tracker (PTG)



Stamp Tracker (Keep track of players/Team's progression):

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker (mark levels earned):

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker Name:

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker Name:

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									



Team/Player Name: _____

THE COVENANT Stamp: _____	 THE CRADLE Stamp: _____	THE CROSS Stamp: _____
THE COMFORTER Stamp: _____	NAMES OF GOD Stamp: _____	TIMES & SEASONS Stamp: _____

Team/Player Name: _____

THE COVENANT Stamp: _____	THE CRADLE Stamp: _____	THE CROSS Stamp: _____
THE COMFORTER Stamp: _____	NAMES OF GOD Stamp: _____	TIMES & SEASONS Stamp: _____

Master Tracker (GRinCH)



Stamp Tracker (Keep track of status/Team's progression):

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker (mark levels earned):

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker Name:

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									

Stamp Tracker Name:

Category	Level 1			Level 2			Level 3		
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons									



The Grid Grind Challenge

How it works:

- Leader calls a CATEGORY + LEVEL (1 = easy, 2 = medium, 3 = challenge) and reads ONE question.
- If you answer correctly, you may mark ANY square on your card with that exact tag (example: [COV-2]).
- If you miss it, you cannot mark that tag this round.
- First to Yell “GRinCH” (5 in a row) wins. “Nailed It” is a **BLACK OUT** card. Keep playing to earn all stamps.

Stamp rule (re-playable):

To earn a lesson stamp, your team must get a correct answer at Level 1, Level 2, and Level 3 for that category (collect 1–2–3).

Category tags:

COV = Covenant | CRA = Cradle | CRO = Cross | COM = Comforter | NOG = Names of God | TS = Numbers/Times/Seasons

Stamp Tracker (Sample):

Category	Level 1	Level 2	Level 3
COV — Covenant	☐	☐	☐
CRA — Cradle	☐	☐	☐
CRO — Cross	☐	☐	☐
COM — Comforter	☐	☐	☐
NOG — Names of God	☐	☐	☐
TS —	☐	☐	☐
Numbers/Times/Seasons			



Grid Iron Card A-1

Covenant [COV-1]	Immanuel [CRA-1]	Atonement [CRO-2]	Comforter [COM-1]	Mo'ed [TS-2]
Promise [COV-2]	Manger [CRA-1]	It is finished [CRO-1]	Power [COM-2]	Jubilee [TS-3]
Abram [COV-3]	With Us [CRA-2]	FREE	Fruit [COM-3]	Seasons [TS-1]
YHWH [NOG-1]	Yeshua [NOG-2]	Ruach HaKodesh [NOG-3]	Selah [NOG-2]	Shabbat [TS-2]
Faithful [COV-2]	Bethlehem [CRA-3]	Redemption [CRO-3]	Helper [COM-1]	Count Your Days (2) [TS-1]

Grid Iron Card A-2

Covenant [COV-3]	Immanuel [CRA-1]	Atonement [CRO-2]	Comforter [COM-1]	Mo'ed [TS-2]
Promise [COV-2]	Manger [CRA-1]	It is finished [CRO-3]	Power [COM-2]	Jubilee [TS-3]
Abram [COV-1]	With Us [CRA-2]	FREE	Fruit [COM-3]	Seasons [TS-1]
YHWH [NOG-2]	Yeshua [NOG-1]	Ruach HaKodesh [NOG-3]	Selah [NOG-2]	Shabbat [TS-2]
Faithful [COV-2]	Bethlehem [CRA-3]	Redemption [CRO-1]	Helper [COM-1]	Count Your Days (4) [TS-1]



Grid Iron Card B-1

Promise [COV-1]	Bethlehem [CRA-3]	Grace [CRO-2]	Helper [COM-1]	Seasons [TS-1]
Covenant [COV-3]	Immanuel [CRA-1]	Atonement [CRO-1]	Comforter [COM-2]	Mo'ed [TS-3]
Faithful [COV-2]	Manger [CRA-2]	FREE	Power [COM-3]	Jubilee [TS-2]
YHWH [NOG-1]	Selah [NOG-3]	Yeshua [NOG-2]	Ruach HaKodesh [NOG-2]	Shabbat [TS-2]
Abram [COV-2]	With Us [CRA-2]	Redemption [CRO-3]	Fruit [COM-1]	Appointed Time [TS-2]

Grid Iron Card B-2

Promise [COV-1]	Bethlehem [CRA-1]	Grace [CRO-3]	Helper [COM-1]	Seasons [TS-1]
Covenant [COV-3]	Immanuel [CRA-1]	Atonement [CRO-1]	Comforter [COM-2]	Mo'ed [TS-3]
Faithful [COV-2]	Manger [CRA-3]	FREE	Power [COM-3]	Jubilee [TS-2]
YHWH [NOG-1]	Selah [NOG-3]	Yeshua [NOG-1]	Ruach HaKodesh [NOG-2]	Shabbat [TS-2]
Abram [COV-2]	With Us [CRA-2]	Redemption [CRO-2]	Fruit [COM-1]	Appointed Time [TS-2]



Grid Iron Card C

Abram [COV-2]	Immanuel [CRA-2]	It is finished [CRO-1]	Comforter [COM-2]	Count Your Days (3) [TS-1]
Covenant [COV-1]	Manger [CRA-1]	Grace [CRO-2]	Helper [COM-1]	Mo'ed [TS-2]
Promise [COV-3]	Bethlehem [CRA-3]	FREE	Power [COM-3]	Jubilee [TS-3]
YHWH [NOG-1]	Ruach HaKodesh [NOG-3]	Selah [NOG-2]	Yeshua [NOG-2]	Shabbat [TS-2]
Faithful [COV-2]	With Us [CRA-1]	Atonement [CRO-3]	Fruit [COM-2]	Seasons [TS-1]

Grid Iron Card C-2

Abram [COV-2]	Immanuel [CRA-2]	It is finished [CRO-1]	Comforter [COM-2]	Count Your Days (9) [TS-1]
Covenant [COV-1]	Manger [CRA-1]	Grace [CRO-2]	Helper [COM-3]	Mo'ed [TS-2]
Promise [COV-3]	Bethlehem [CRA-3]	FREE	Power [COM-1]	Jubilee [TS-1]
YHWH [NOG-1]	Elohim [NOG-1]	Selah [NOG-2]	Yeshua [NOG-2]	Eight [TS-2]
Faithful [COV-3]	With Us [CRA-1]	Atonement [CRO-3]	Fruit [COM-2]	Seasons [TS-3]

Holiday Edition – AE Activity Answer Key Appendix

Use this appendix for grading, prep, or quick reference.

Reflection, discussion, and group questions are personal and will vary—there is no single “right” answer.

Lesson 1 — THE COVENANT (AE)

Activity – Fill in the Blanks

- A covenant is a sacred, binding agreement God initiated.
 - God promised that all families on earth would be blessed through Abraham.
 - Jesus’ birth is the fulfillment of God’s ancient promise.
 - God’s promises stand because of His faithfulness, not our perfection.
-

Lesson 2 — THE CRADLE (AE)

Activity – “Cradle Connections” (Matching)

1. Isaiah 7:14 → A. God with us (Immanuel)
 2. Luke 2:7 → B. Jesus’ humble birth
 3. John 1:14 → C. The Word became flesh
 4. Philippians 2:6–8 → D. The Humble King (He emptied Himself)
-

Lesson 3 — THE CROSS (AE)

Activity – “Cross Connection” (Matching)

(Terms → Meanings)

1. A. Atonement → 3. Jesus paying for our sins
 2. B. Redemption → 2. Being bought back by Christ
 3. C. Love → 4. God’s motivation for the cross
 4. D. “It is finished.” → 1. “Paid in full”; Jesus’ victory declaration
-

Lesson 4 — THE COMFORTER (AE)

Activities – Reflection/Discussion (No fixed-answer key)

Bonus Lesson — Youth Names of God (Answer Key)

Activity 1 – Fill in the Blank

1. There is no letter J in the Hebrew alphabet.
2. The name Yeshua means “Yahweh saves.”

3. The Holy Spirit in Hebrew is called “Ruach HaKodesh.”
 4. Selah means “pause and reflect.”
 5. Amen means “Let it be so” (or “truly”).
-

Bonus Lesson — TIMES & SEASONS (Answer Key)

Activity – Match the Meaning (AE) — Answer Key

- 50 → D. Year of Jubilee
- 7 → C. Completion
- 8 → A. New Beginning
- 2 → B. Witness

Key Terms (from the lesson):

Mo’ed → an appointed time / season

Shabbat → rest (Sabbath)

Jubilee → liberty + restoration (Leviticus 25)

CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Creator, Soul Food Series

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown, MBAE, MSIT, DD

Contact & Orders

For booking inquiries: overflowharvest@gmail.com

For bulk orders: kingdomlivingproject2020@gmail.com

Evangelist Rose Doctor

Email: redroseofgrace@gmail.com

Major Ministry Contributors

Dr. Temia Joy Julius

Senior Pastor, Kingdom Revelation International Ministries

CEO, Temia Joy’s Events and Consulting

Email: temiajoyevents@gmail.com

TikTok: @temiajoy

Pastor Michael Edwards II

Email: michael.edwards2@yahoo.com

TikTok: @dopestpastor

Faith Destiny Helpers

With heartfelt gratitude to the following “Destiny Helpers” whose prayers, encouragement, advocacy, and support helped birth and sustain this work:

- **Co-Pastor Johnetta Baymon**, Deliverance Center Ministries COGIC
- **James R. Johnson**, COO, Pearl Development Group, Inc.
- **Apostle Linda Edwards**, Overseer, Kingdom Revelation International Ministries
- **Jafari O. Brown**, IT Web DevOps Consultant
- Mother Vicki Frisby, IT Consultant
- **Sandra Gethers**, My ‘843’ Sounding Board
- Min. Crystal Green, Intercessor
- **Simpson L. Doctor**, *Poet* “Prayer for Divine Connection”
- **The Browns, LDH** and morethank you!

Music & Media Credits

With appreciation to the ministers and creatives whose gifts in music and media help carry this message beyond the page:

- JNR Robinson, *Never Knew*, (2010)
- Harold Lee, *We All We Got* - Feat. Streetz Young, Elicia Dunston, (2023)
- Apostle Linda Edwards, *Three in One*, (2023)
- Kossi Bruno, *A Friend*, (2019)

Wellness Support Team

Charleston Wellness Center – thank you for reminding us that spiritual work flourishes best when mind, body, and soul are cared for together.

Editors

To my editors – including the gifted freelancers who labored behind their online pen names – thank you for your attentive eyes, patient revisions, and for helping me carry the heart of this message with clarity and excellence. Your quiet, faithful work is felt on every page.

Reference & Study Resources

Historical, linguistic, and cultural insights for the instructors and teachers- extended study materials have been formed by standard biblical reference works, concordances, and reputable academic sources, as outlined in the Reference & Historical Source Index (Instructor Edition) for this series. These tools were used under educational Fair Use to provide context, clarity, and enrichment for teachers and students alike.

FaithTech & Digital Tools

Special thanks to the emerging world of FaithTech and “greater works” digital tools that helped make this project possible at a fraction of the traditional cost, multiplying reach while honoring the message of the Gospel.

Above all, I give glory to God for every person, prayer, tool, and resource that has helped turn Soul Food from a vision into a living, teaching ministry on the page.

Why Soul Food?

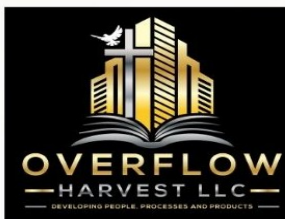


Series Founder, Dr. Brown

Growing up in Boston, my grandmother, Pastor Pearl Doctor, **always brought both the food and the Word to the table.** You couldn't walk into her home without smelling something cooking and hearing something spiritual on the radio. Whether you came in upset, excited, nervous, or afraid, she would bring you back to center—with the Word of God in one hand and a plate of food in the other.

She didn't wait until Sunday to offer support. She lived what I now call: ***Truth Served Daily***—sharing God's Word like Heavenly bread alongside whatever she had on the stove. I watched family, and friends, alike find peace in that kind of soul food, the kind that nourishes the inner person and prepares us for more than the moment we're in.

This Soul Food Bible Study workbook was born from that legacy. Designed for **personal devotion or Bible study circles, use in cell group ministry, and Sunday school settings**, each lesson offers bite-sized, life-giving “courses” to help you grow in wholeness, deepen fellowship, and share what God is doing in you with others. My hope is that these pages bring comfort, clarity, and courage—and inspire you to pass that soul food along. Be blessed!



OVERFLOW HARVEST, LLC: SOUL FOOD HOLIDAY,
ADULT EDITION ALL RIGHTS RESERVED © 2025